



— FREE 15-MINUTE GUIDE

Workflow Idea Starter Kit

Turn one recurring problem into a system you can actually reuse.

AMY NOTE

Start with the chaos. Keep the judgment human. Let the right AI do the heavy lifting.

Inside, you will:

- see the Workaround Amy way of looking at repeated work
- fill your thinking directly into one copy/paste prompt
- ask AI for a first-version system
- use your judgment to choose what is useful, what is too much, and what stays human

The goal is not to build a perfect system. The goal is to make the next time easier.

The Amy Way

Most people start with the tool. I do not.

I start with the part of the work that keeps coming back and asking for more brain space than it deserves. Before I open ChatGPT, Gemini, a spreadsheet, a form, or a dashboard, I ask: what is actually repeating here?

The repeated email. The repeated decision. The repeated explanation. The repeated scramble. The repeated “wait, where does that live again?”

1

Find the repeat.

Look for the part that shows up again and again.

2

Choose the container.

Pick the simplest home for it: checklist, template, form, prompt, dashboard, or workflow.

3

Plan the handoff.

Use AI for structure and drafting. Keep judgment, context, and final decisions human.

AMY NOTE

AI does not remove the thinking. It gives the thinking somewhere to land.

This guide is here to help you notice one piece of repeated work, give the tool enough context to be useful, and then use your judgment to choose a first version worth trying.

A Quick Example

Sometimes it helps to see what this looks like before you try it yourself.

Recurring problem:

I keep rewriting the same weekly staff reminder email.

Name the chaos

Information lives in too many places: calendar, notes, old emails, random reminders, and my brain.

Find the repeat

Dates, reminders, links, action items, and a short tone-setting message.

Choose the container

A weekly checklist, a reusable email template, and a place to collect reminders as they appear.

Plan the handoff

AI can organize notes and draft. I keep tone, timing, sensitive context, and final edits.

AI might say:

This looks like a weekly communication workflow. Start with a reusable staff email template and one simple place to collect reminders during the week. Do not automate yet - test the template once, then adjust what still had to live in your brain.

First version:

Weekly Staff Reminder Builder: a simple Google Doc template with sections for dates, reminders, links, and action items.

AMY NOTE

When you can explain the mess this clearly, you are already halfway to the system.

The 5-Question Prompt

You do not need a separate worksheet. Type your answers directly into the brackets. Messy is fine. The tool can help sort it.

I want to turn one recurring problem into a simple reusable workflow.

1. What keeps coming back?

[Type your answer here.]

2. What makes it frustrating?

[Type your answer here.]

3. What seems to repeat each time?

[Information, steps, decisions, communication, timing, people involved, etc.]

4. What would make the next time easier?

[Type your answer here.]

5. What needs to stay human?

[Final decisions, relationships, confidential information, ethics, context, judgment, etc.]

Optional: Where does this work live right now?

[Email, calendar, Google Doc, spreadsheet, notes app, someone's brain, etc.]

Please help me:

- identify the repeatable parts
- recommend the simplest useful system type
- separate what AI can help with from what should stay human
- sketch a first version I could build this week
- point out anything I might be overbuilding

Keep it practical, clear, and not overbuilt.

AMY NOTE

Your job is not to have the whole system figured out. Your job is to give the tool enough context to be useful.

Choose the Smallest Useful Version

Do not build the biggest version. Look at what AI gives you and choose the part that would actually help next time.

If the first answer is too complex, tell it: **“Make this simpler and give me the smallest useful first version.”**

Ask yourself:

- What part of this would actually help next time?
- What feels too complicated?
- What needs human judgment before I use it?
- Where should this live so I can find it again?
- What can I try once this week?

Quick container guide:

Checklist	for remembering steps
Template	for repeated language
Prompt	for thinking, drafting, or sorting
Form	for collecting information
Tracker	for following status over time
Dashboard	for seeing status at a glance
Calendar	for timing, routines, or follow-up
Doc	for a reusable guide or shared reference

AMY NOTE

A good first version is not impressive. It is usable. Try it once. Notice what broke. Make it better.

Build the system once. Save your brain for the work that actually needs you.

Workaround Amy | Practical AI systems for school, work, and life.